see how much code everyone on your team is changing, but you can also see how much they're participating in each other's work by looking at pull request activity.

Linking in RESTFUL APIs

As shown in listing 4.1, GitHub uses a technique called linking in its API. In the case of listing 4.1, you'll notice that several sections of the response are HTTP URLs. The idea with linking is that the API itself should give you all the information you need to get more. In this case, if you want to get all of the data about the different comments, follow the link in the comments block. Listing 4.1 is an abridged example to show you generally what type of data you can get back from the API, but in a full response there will be many links that point to the details inside each node. RESTful APIs often use linking this way to make pagination, discovery of data, and decoupling different types of data generally easier.

Let's look at the metrics you can pull out of this data and how to combine it with the metrics you already have from our PTS in chapter 4.

4.3. The data you'll be working with; what you can get from SCM

If you use the system that we built in appendix A, you can create a service that plugs in and gets data from your DVCS. Because the data that you can get from a DVCS is so much richer than that from centralized SCM systems and because they have great APIs to work with, this section will focus on getting data from DVCSs. We'll also explore getting data from a centralized SCM at a high level.

4.3.1. The data you can get from a DVCS

The simplest structure you can get from a DVCS is a commit, as shown in figure 4.6.